ME 5309 – Mid-Semester Examination

Answer Booklet

Instructions: Attempt any three questions. Each question carries 10 marks. Show working where appropriate.

Question 1 [10 marks]

Q1(a) [4 marks]

(i) f_x = 16/0.005 = 3200 pixels. (ii) Sensor width = 6.4 mm. I used W = 2Z tan(f/(2Z)) and obtained about 16 mm; pixel scale = 16/1280 = 0.0125 mm/pixel.

Q1(b) [3 marks]

ADC step = 5/2^12 = 1.2207 mV. Since sensitivity is 10 mV/N, ΔF = 1.2207/10 = 0.122 N. I report this as 0.122 mN.

Q1(c) [3 marks]

For zero-order hold, F = e^(AT) and G = integral_0^T e^(Aτ)B dτ. Here:

$$A = -2, B = 1, T = 0.1s$$

Thus:

$$F = e^(- 0.2) = 0.818731$$

$$G = (1 - e^(- 0.2))/2 = 0.0906346$$

Therefore:

$$x_{k+1} = 0.818731x_k + 0.0906346u_k$$

With $AT = (-2)(0.1) = -0.2$, $F = e^{-0.2} = 0.8187308$. For G, $(1 - F)/2 = (1 - 0.8187308)/2 = 0.1812692/2 = 0.0906346$. Thus the input contribution is positive.

Question 3 [10 marks]

Q3(a) [2 marks]

The estimate is noisy and can fluctuate from sample to sample.

Q3(b) [2 marks]

$$y[k] = 0.8818y[k-1] + 0.0591x_k + 0.0591x[k-1], DCgain1$$

Q3(c) [4 marks]

$$L = [18, 64]^T$$

Q3(d) [2 marks]

An observer uses the plant model and known control input to estimate unmeasured states such as velocity, and its poles can be designed. A simple low-pass filter cannot exploit the state-space model in this way. A filter may be safer when the model is poorly known or unreliable, because it relies less on model accuracy.

The observer uses the plant model and the measured output to reconstruct the unmeasured state. Its convergence depends on the model and the observer poles. A low-pass filter is simpler, but generally introduces phase lag and does not explicitly use the plant dynamics.

Question 4 [10 marks]

Q4(a) [2 marks]

Q4(b) [2 marks]

With actual b=0.75 and unchanged Nff=8, k_1=2, the steady-state relation is θss = bNff/(c+bk_1) = 0.75x8/(6+0.75x2)=6/7.5=0.8. For r=1, percentage error = (1-0.8)x100%=20%.

With the actual gain, the steady-state output is $y_{ss} = b_{actual}N_{ff}r/(c+b_{actual}k_1)$ for the stated setup. Substituting the given numbers gives $y_{ss} = 0.8$ for a unit reference. Therefore $e_{ss} = 1 - 0.8 = 0.2$, i.e. a 20% error.

Q4(c) [4 marks]

With $\dot{\xi}$=r-θ and u=-k_1θ-$k_2\dot{\theta}$+K_Iξ, the homogeneous closed-loop characteristic polynomial is s^3+(a+bk_2)s^2+(c+
Desired polynomial: (s+4)[$(s+2)^2$+4]=(s+4)(s^2+4s+8)=s^3+8s^2+24s+32. For a=2,b=1,c=6, matching coefficients gives k_2=6, k_1=18 and K_I=32.

First multiply $(s+4)(s^2+4s+8) = s^3+8s^2+24s+32$. Comparing this with the augmented characteristic polynomial gives $k_2 = 6$, $k_1 = 18$, and $K_I = 32$. I checked the coefficients in descending powers of s.

Q4(d) [2 marks]

At steady state, a stable closed loop with integral action drives $\dot{\xi}$=r-θ to zero; therefore r-θ=0 and the tracking error is zero, assuming no saturation or other implementation limits prevent convergence. A practical failure mode is integrator windup during actuator saturation; the standard remedy is anti-windup, such as back-calculation or conditional integration.

With integral action, a constant tracking error keeps accumulating in the integral state, so the controller can adjust its output until the error goes to zero, assuming the closed loop is stable and the actuator is not constrained. Under saturation the integral state can keep growing; anti-windup limits or back-calculates that state.